Paclitaxel Protein Bound: Abraxane

Original Effective Date: 5/2/2022
Revision Date(s): 9/2021, 11/2022, 12/2022, 7/2023, 12/2023, 4/8/2024, 5/23/2024, 9/4/2024, 11/4/2024, 5/27/2025, 7/1/2026
Review Date: 7/1/2026
Policy type: Medical Necessity
Line of Business: All G.E.H.A Medical Plans

Authorizations are issued for 6 (six) months, unless the ordering physician requests a different timespan or the patients' unique circumstance or condition supports the medical necessity for a different authorization timeframe. Reauthorization requests are reviewed for efficacy, safety and tolerability.

Preference	Requires Prior Auth	Drug Name	HCPCS Code	Description
Preferred	No	**Docetaxel (Taxotere)**	**J9171**	Injection, docetaxel, 1 mg
Preferred	No	**Docetaxel (Hospira 505(b)(2))**	**J9232**	Injection, docetaxel (Hospira), not therapeutically equivalent to J9171, 1 mg
Preferred	Yes	**Paclitaxel (Taxol)**	**J9267**	Injection, paclitaxel, 1 mg
Non-Preferred**	Yes	**Paclitaxel Protein-Bound (Abraxane)**	**J9264**	Injection, paclitaxel protein-bound particles, 1 mg

**Does not apply in the setting of Pancreatic Cancer, Ampullary Adenocarcinoma, and Biliary Tract Cancers.

- Members must have documentation of a contraindication, failure, or intolerance to any of the preferred agents (or their 505(b)(2) equivalents) prior to approval of a non-preferred product, when clinically appropriate.
- Preferred product requirements apply to new starts only.
- Step Therapy applies to all overlapping compendia supported indications/regimens.

Universal Approval Criteria:

Unless otherwise noted, the review criteria used by OncoHealth to determine medical necessity for anticancer treatments and supportive agents include, but is not limited to:

- National Comprehensive Cancer Network® (NCCN) - use consistent with NCCN recommendations carrying a Category 1 or 2A level of evidence; **OR**
- United States Food and Drug Administration (FDA) labeling - new drugs or regimens (combinations of drugs) consistent with the product labeling; **OR**
- Indications not included in the official FDA labeling or recommended by NCCN (Category 1 or 2A level of evidence) may be considered if determined to be medically necessary per one or more of the following compendia:
    - Clinical Pharmacology (Strong For); **OR**
    - Wolters Kluwer Lexi-Drugs® (Level A); **OR**